



AN ALPHABET OF CELEBRITIES

BY OLIVER HERFORD

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CELEBRITIES ***

AN ALPHABET OF CELEBRITIES

Oliver Herford



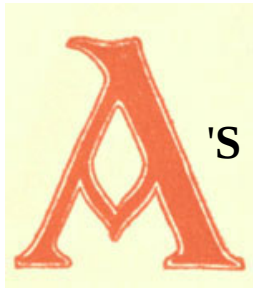
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AN ALPHABET
OF CELEBRITIES

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Albert Edward, well meaning but flighty,

Who invited King **A**thur, the blameless and
mighty,

To meet **A**lcibiades and **A**phrodite.



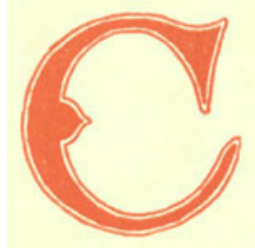


is for **B**ernhardt, who fails to awaken

Much feeling in **B**ismarck, **B**arabbas, and

Bacon.





is C olumbus, who tries to explain

How to balance an egg—to the utter disdain

Of C onfucius, C arlyle, C leopatra, and C ain.





'S

for **D**iogenes, **D**arwin, and **D**ante,

Who delight in the dance Of a **D**arling

Bacchante.





is for E^dison, making believe

He's invented a clever contrivance for E^ve,

Who complained that she never could laugh in her
sleeve.





is for **F**ranklin, who fearfully shocks

The feelings of **F**enelon, **F**aber, and **F**ox.





is **G**odiva, whose great bareback feat

Though **G**ounod and **G**oldsmith implore and
entreat.



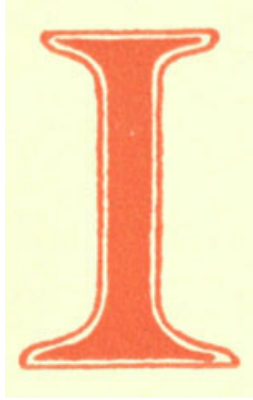


is for **H**andel, who pours out his soul

Through the bagpipes to **H**owells and **H**omer,
who roll

On the floor in an ecstasy past all control.





is for **I**bsen, reciting a play

While **I**rving and **I**ngersoll hasten away.





is for **J**ohnson, who only says

"Pish!"

To **J**onah, who tells him his tale of a fish.





is the **K**aiser, who kindly repeats

Some original verses to **K**ipling and **K**eats.





is Lafontaine, who finds he's unable

To interest Luther and Liszt in his fable,

While Loie continues to dance on the table.





is Macduff, who's prevailed upon Milton

And Montaigne and Manon to each try a kilt on.





is Napoléon, shrouded in gloom,

With Nero, Narcissus, and Nordau, to whom

He's explaining the manual of arms with a broom.





is for **O**liver, casting aspersion

On **O**mar, that awfully dissolute Persian,

Though secretly longing to join the diversion.





is for **P**eter, who hollers "No! No!"

Through the keyhole to **P**aine, **P**aderewski, and

Poe.

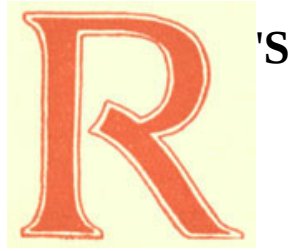




is the **Q**ueen, so noble and free—

For further particulars look under V.





Rubenstein, playing that old thing in F

To Rollo and Rembrandt, who wish they were
deaf.





'S

is for **S**winburne, who, seeking
the true,
the good, and the beautiful, visits the Zoo,

Where he chances on **S**appho and Mr. **S**ardou,

And **S**ocrates, all with the same end in view.



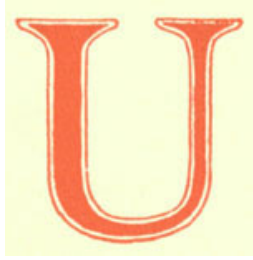


is for T alleyrand toasting Miss T ruth,

By the side of her well, in a glass of vermouth,

And presenting Mark T wain as the friend of his
youth.





is for U ndine, pursuing U lysses

And U mberto, who flee her damp, death-dealing
kisses.





is **V**ictoria, noble and true—

For further particulars look under Q.





Wagner, who sang and played lots for
Washington, Wesley, and good Doctor
Watts.

His prurient plots pained Wesley and Watts,

But Washington said he "enjoyed them in spots."





is **X**antippe, who's having her say,

His prurient plots pained **W**esley and **W**atts,

And frightening the army of **X**erxes away.





is for Y oung, the great Mormon saint,

Who thinks little Y um Y um and Y vette so
quaint,

He has to be instantly held in restraint.

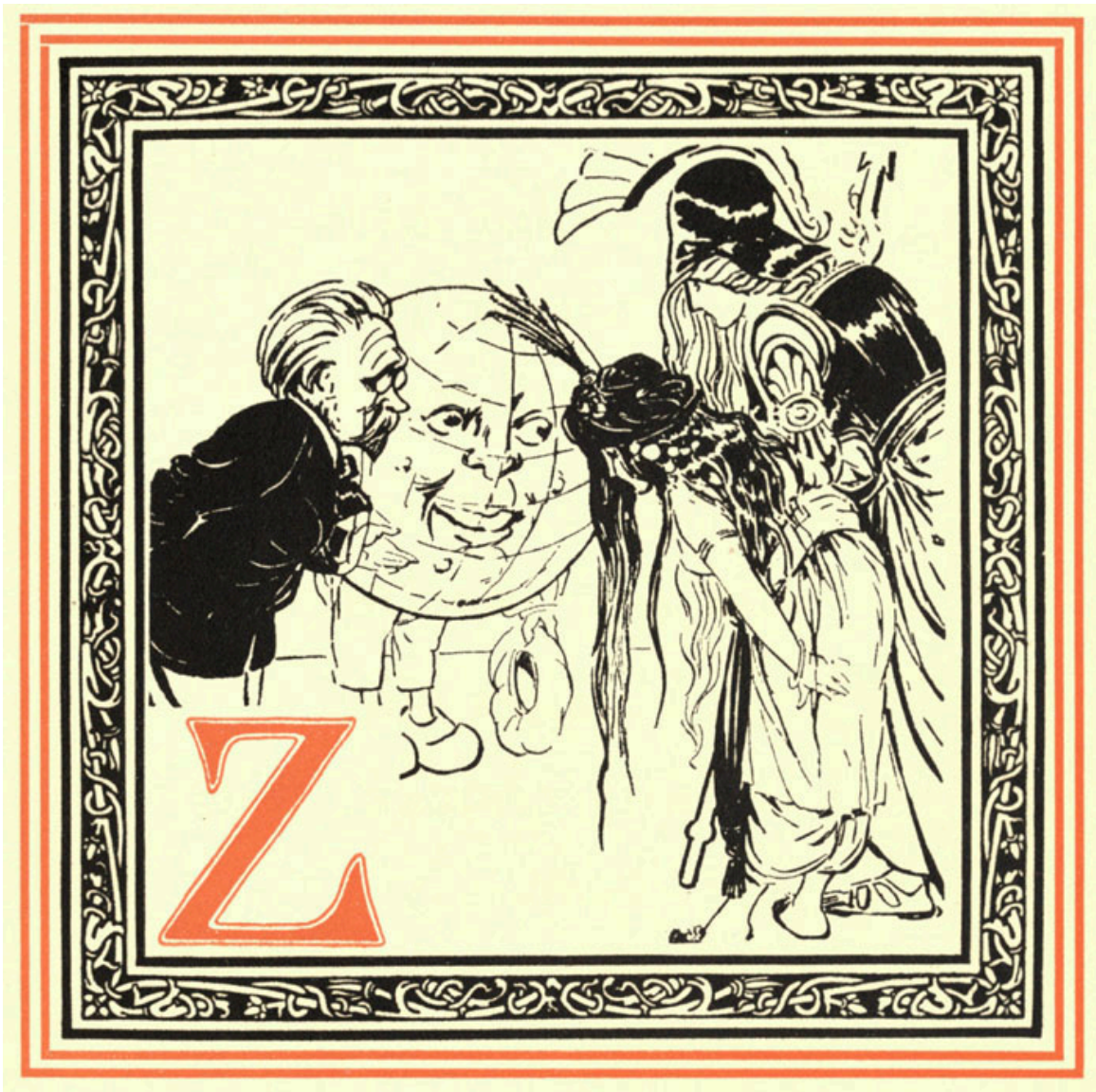




is for **Z**ola, presenting *La Terre*

To **Z**enobia the brave and **Z**uleika the fair,

Whose blushes they artfully conceal with their
hair.





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